# Investment Project Rubrics

BUS331 Investment Committee Simulation | Written submission and live presentation defense

## How the assessment works

Canvas remains the authority for due dates, submission mechanics, and course-grade weights. Use the Investment Project Submission rubric for the Phase 3 Excel workbook and the Investment Project Presentation rubric for the Phase 4 integrated oral presentation and defense.

| Project submission | Presentation and defense | Submission authority |
|---|---|---|
| **100-point Canvas rubric** | **100-point Canvas rubric** | Canvas controls due dates, file requirements, and the project course-grade weight. |

## Evidence chain the committee must defend

Phase 1 client and macro evidence and Phase 2 security research inform the Phase 3 Excel portfolios. Phase 4 connects the economic review, IPS statements, research, weights and risk decisions in one oral presentation. Role ownership is individual; the final decision is collective.

AI may challenge a judgment or help debug a process, but it is not evidence. Material claims must be verified with approved sources, including properly documented FactSet retrievals where required.

## Phase 3 Excel workbook

| Criterion | Weight | Decision-ready standard |
|---|---|---|
| **Evidence quality & technical accuracy** | **20%** | The provided Reference data, source dates, three class adjustments, category-specific expected and downside returns, covariance/correlation and annualization are used accurately and interpreted. Category total returns include income; security histories estimate price-return risk. A class shift changes the mean while reference SD remains unchanged. |
| **Focused security selection** | **20%** | Each client has 10 distinct securities with positive final weights, correct class and sector/category classifications, and explicit client-role rationale. The selected category determines its historical baseline; the common Equity, Bond or Cash change supplies the adjustment. Research supports fit, costs, liquidity, overlap and concentration decisions. |
| **Client suitability & IPS compliance** | **15%** | Each recommendation traces to the client IPS and relevant RRTTLLLU objectives and constraints. Return goals, allocation limits, liquidity, suitability and downside tripwires are checked and explained. |
| **Shared portfolio quality & risk response** | **25%** | Initial, Solver and final weights are retained and total 100%. Client-specific covariance matrices, Solver constraints and outcomes, final judgment, stress results, corrections and monitoring triggers form one internally consistent portfolio decision. |
| **Individual role evidence & decision trail** | **20%** | Summary identifies each member contribution. Workbook explanations document the initial judgment, Solver result, final recommendation, rejected alternative, key trade-off, verification and unresolved reservations. No separate Phase 3 Decision Record is required. |

# Oral Committee Defense

Compact defense within the final presentation | Every member owns role evidence and the integrated recommendation

| Criterion | Weight | Decision-ready standard |
|---|---|---|
| **Role-specific committee defense** | **25%** | Within the presentation's compact investment-committee defense, each member answers targeted questions for their role, uses relevant evidence and calculations, acknowledges uncertainty, and defends or revises the judgment under challenge. |
| **Individual evidence & workbook contribution** | **20%** | Each member demonstrates command of owned evidence and can explain their recommendation, alternative rejected, key trade-off, workbook contribution, verification, and limitations. |
| **Shared portfolio quality & integration** | **25%** | The committee presents one coherent chain from client scenario analysis through the 10-security-per-client selection, final weights, overlap/concentration decisions, stress results, residual-risk conclusion, correction, and final recommendation. |
| **Client suitability & risk compliance** | **20%** | Members can show where client needs changed the portfolio, explain the strongest bear case and residual risk, and defend compliance, corrective action, and the residual-risk conclusion. |
| **Clarity, professionalism & visual evidence** | **10%** | The team communicates concisely as client-focused professionals and uses legible exhibits that make the recommendation, trade-offs, and evidence visible. |

## Defense standard

The compact investment-committee defense is part of the final presentation. Each member answers targeted role questions, uses the relevant evidence or calculation, explains their workbook contribution, alternative rejected, and key trade-off, acknowledges uncertainty, and states whether the challenge changes the decision.

# Committee Question Bank

Prepare across roles - not only for the section you present

## Client and Macro Strategist

- Which Phase 1 client fact or guardrail most changed the final portfolio, and where can the committee see that change?
- Which macro assumption matters most to this recommendation, and what evidence would cause the team to revise it?
- Which unresolved client information gap remains material, and how did the portfolio avoid pretending it was known?

## Fixed-Income Analyst

- Why does the selected fixed-income exposure fit the client's cash-flow horizon better than the strongest alternative?
- What happens to price and income if rates or credit spreads move against the position, and which duration or credit evidence supports that answer?
- What did the Holding & Exposure Reality Check reveal about concentration, liquidity, costs, key risk, and the allocation implication for the selected fixed-income exposure?

## Equity Analyst

- Why does the selected equity fund or ETF deliver the needed exposure better than the strongest alternative after costs, liquidity, overlap, and style or sector concentration?
- If the portfolio includes an individual equity, why is it superior to a fund or ETF for that role, what is its idiosyncratic risk, and why is the position size appropriate?
- Which equity candidate did you reject, and what key trade-off separated it from your recommendation?

## Portfolio Manager

- Which analyst recommendations did you integrate, resize, or reject, and what explicit portfolio trade-off drove each decision?
- Where did you resolve overlap or concentration, and why are the final 10 holdings and weights better than the strongest alternative mix?
- If the committee rejects one proposed adjustment, what alternative preserves the client goal and what new trade-off does it create?

## Risk and Derivatives Analyst

- Which residual risk contributes most to the bear-case loss, and which client goal is therefore most exposed?
- Why is the supported conclusion hedge or no hedge, and what evidence makes that conclusion preferable to changing the underlying holdings or weights?
- If a hedge is proposed, explain the instrument, size, cost, liquidity, trade-offs, residual risk, and adjustment or removal condition.

## Any committee member

- What was the team's strongest initial judgment that changed after AI challenge and human verification?
- Which FactSet retrieval most affected the recommendation, how did you interpret it, and where is the licensed-source evidence retained under course policy?
- Which source or calculation carries the most decision weight, and what are its limitations?
- What is the strongest reasonable case against the final recommendation?
- What monitoring trigger would force the committee to reconvene before the normal review date?

# Submission Readiness

Use this checklist for the Phase 3 workbook and Phase 4 presentation

## Phase 3 workbook

[ ] Each client has 10 distinct positive-weight securities; 61 aligned STOCKHISTORY closes support 60 returns.

[ ] Covariance/correlation matrices, Solver comparisons, constraints and messages are complete.

[ ] The recommendation is stated clearly for all assigned clients.

[ ] Every material claim, input, calculation, and as-of date is traceable.

[ ] Bond, mutual-fund, and ETF decisions show real comparison and instrument-specific evidence.

[ ] Holding & Exposure Reality Checks, any conditional direct-security add-ons, and FactSet retrieval records are complete.

[ ] Each holding traces to a Phase 1 client guardrail and has a portfolio job and monitoring trigger.

[ ] The full IPS scorecard and bear-case test are complete; every breach is corrected and re-tested.

[ ] The Phase 3 workbook records initial judgment, Solver results, verification, final reasoning and individual contributions.

[ ] Submit only the completed XLSX in Phase 3 and the PowerPoint file in Phase 4; retain licensed research privately under course policy.

## Phase 4 oral defense

[ ] Each member can defend owned work and explain the complete decision chain.

[ ] The committee can show where a client need or constraint changed the final portfolio.

[ ] The team can explain the strongest bear case, closest warning or breach, and corrective action.

[ ] Every member can identify the most decision-useful source, calculation, limitation, and monitoring trigger.

[ ] Visual exhibits are legible and make the recommendation, trade-offs, and evidence visible.